

FACTFILE
NOTABLE MEMBERS
THE BEAST
 Demon with mystical powers
WITCH
 Martial arts and occult magic
SHADOW
 Martial arts and occult magic
THOUGHT
 Martial arts and occult magic
IRON
 Martial arts and occult magic
WOMAN
 Martial arts and occult magic
WOLVERINE
 Martial arts and occult magic

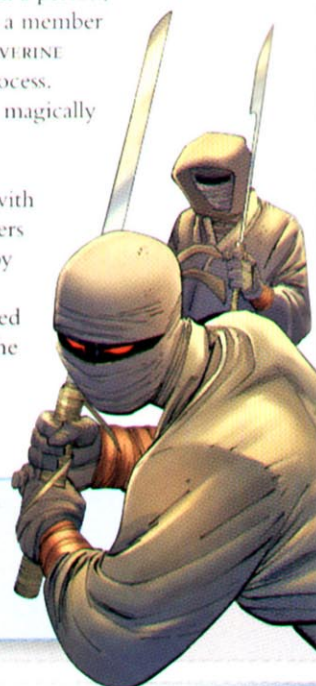
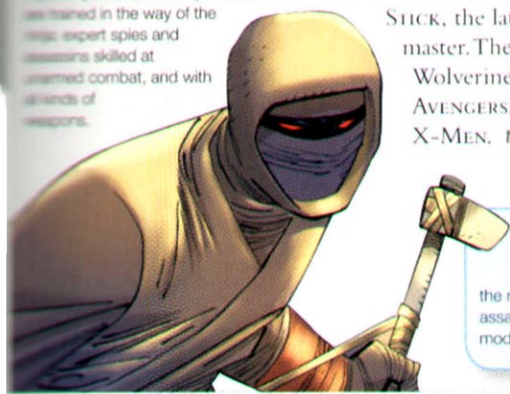
FIRST APPEARANCE
Daredevil #168 (January 1981)

HAND, THE

The Hand is a cult of mystical ninjas involved with organized crime and often hired to carry out assassinations. The Hand dates back to 16th-century Japan, where the cult adapted classical ninjitsu techniques to its own evil purposes. The Hand's activities have now spread throughout the world. Hand operatives are servants of a demon known only as the Beast. Skilled in the use of powerful occult magic, they can kill a person, then bring that person back to life as a member of the Hand. Only ELEKTRA and WOLVERINE have ever been able to reverse this process. If one of the Hand is killed, his body magically turns to dust in order to prevent identification.

The Hand has most often clashed with DAREDEVIL, Elektra, and other members of the clan of warriors once led by STICK, the late martial arts master. They have also battled Wolverine, SPIDER-MAN, the AVENGERS, and the X-MEN. **MT**

Implacable, faceless killers, the Hand cult remains one of the most feared groups of assassins at large in the modern world.



HARKNESS, AGATHA

FIRST APPEARANCE *Fantastic Four* #94 (March 1969)
REAL NAME Agatha Harkness
OCCUPATION Witch **BASE** New York City
HEIGHT 5 ft 11 in **WEIGHT** 130 lbs **EYES** Blue **HAIR** White
SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Could manipulate magical forces through the recitation of spells; possessed magical familiar named Ebony, a pet cat that could transform into a vicious panther.

Agatha Harkness was raised in the town of New Salem, Colorado, whose inhabitants practiced magic. She excelled in her craft and eventually became the town's most powerful sorceress and leader. Agatha believed that witches and warlocks didn't have to live apart from normal humans. Her son and the town elders disagreed and she chose to leave New Salem. After moving to Whisper Hill, New York, she was hired as the governess for Franklin RICHARDS, son of Mr. FANTASTIC and INVISIBLE WOMAN. When the SCARLET WITCH became unbalanced and disassembled the Avengers, she apparently murdered Agatha. However, Agatha has been reported dead before and has returned. **TD**



HARDBALL

FIRST APPEARANCE *Avengers: The Initiative* #1 (March 2007)
REAL NAME Roger Brokenridge
OCCUPATION HYDRA agent **BASE** Camp Hammond
HEIGHT 6 ft **WEIGHT** 200 lbs **EYES** Green **HAIR** Blond
SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Creates and throws a number of different types of balls of energy.



Roger never wanted to be a hero. His brother Paul purchased powers from the POWER BROKER and then became paralyzed in a wrestling match. When Roger confronted the Power Broker, he signed up for his own powers. Trying to rob an armored car, he accidentally saved a little girl and became a hero. The Power Broker sold Roger's contract to HYDRA, and Roger became part of the first class of cadets at Camp Hammond and spied on the organization from within. Recently, he killed Senator Woodman (see WOODMAN, SENATOR), who had been in charge of HYDRA, and became the leader himself. **MF**

HAVOK

The brother of the X-Men leader Cyclops, Alex Summers was separated from his sibling following the death of their parents. Although Alex's mutant abilities developed during puberty, his mutant college professor, Ahmet Abdol, was the first to recognize them. After absorbing the cosmic energy stored in Alex's body, Abdol became the Living Monolith, but was defeated by the X-Men. Reunited with his brother, Alex joined the X-Men. Despite working in Cyclops' shadow, he later led X-Factor and fought to save the dark and twisted Earth-1298. He has long had a romantic relationship with the mutant POLARIS. At one point, he fell in love with his nurse from when he was in a coma, but she left him when she realized life near the X-Men was too dangerous. Since then, he and Polaris seem to be patching up their relationship. They are currently working with the STARJAMMERS to put an end to the plans for galactic conquest of Havok's long-hidden brother VULCAN. **AD, MF**



FACTFILE
REAL NAME Alexander "Alex" Summers
OCCUPATION Adventurer; X-Man
BASE New York State
HEIGHT 6 ft
WEIGHT 180 lbs
EYES Brown
HAIR Blond
FIRST APPEARANCE *X-Men* #54 (March 1969)

Havok can absorb solar energy and project it either in an omni-directional wave or in the form of plasma bolts of intense heat, which causes objects to shatter or burn up.

HAVOK

POWERS